CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

HOME HEALTH AIDE IN THE AI ERA

Real care, in real homes — the job AI discourse forgets is the one growing older with the whole country.

★ TL;DR — Around $45K median on this site's band, with short agency training measured in weeks (1–6 month band) and no license gate. The catch: physically and emotionally intimate work whose pay depends heavily on agency vs private clients. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

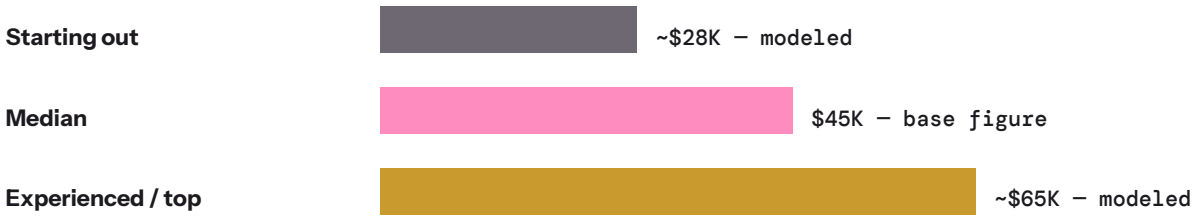
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$45K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW

- The fastest, lowest-barrier entry into healthcare work on this entire list.
- Demand is structural: people age at home, and families buy help they trust.
- The work is nearly automation-proof because it is physical, personal and inside private homes.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Home Health Aide is a ~$45K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A HOME HEALTH AIDE ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Help clients with bathing, dressing, toileting and safe movement

- ✓ Prepare meals, tidy living spaces and run light errands
- ✓ Watch for changes — appetite, mobility, mood — and report them to the agency or family
- ✓ Provide companionship; for many clients you're the day's main human contact

Think: a trusted family member by profession — part helper, part early-warning system.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Almost nothing of the core work: apps handle scheduling, visit verification and care-plan checklists. The care itself is a human in a home.	Everything: trust inside someone's home, noticing decline, keeping dignity intact during intimate care. There is no automated version of this that families would accept.

⚠ **You will be alone in homes with vulnerable people: boundaries, documentation and honesty protect you as much as them. And the lifting is real — learn transfers properly or your back pays.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ One-on-one work instead of ward chaos ✓ Flexible schedules — part-time is genuinely possible ✓ You're thanked by families in a way institutions rarely manage	✗ Intimate care: bathing, toileting, decline, death ✗ Solo work — no team, no backup nearby ✗ Agency pay starts low and hours can be scattered

Good fit? Warm, observant and reliable to your core — families will trust you with everything. Bad fit? You can't handle intimate personal care, or you need coworkers around you.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — THE AGENCY ROUTE	DOOR B — PRIVATE-DUTY CLIENTS
Apply to a home care agency: they interview, background-check and train you through orientation and shadowing, then assign clients. Fast, practical, and the standard way in.	Private families hire aides directly, often through referrals and registries, and usually pay better. Less protection and no backup when you're sick — take this door once you have experience and references.

Smart move: Become the aide families request by name: consistent scheduling, written visit notes, and noticing small changes early. In private duty, reputation is the entire business model. Where you land after: Home health aide → consistent private-duty clients, agency senior aide — or the natural first step toward CNA and nursing credentials.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
CHOOSE YOUR	COMPLETE AGENCY	SHADOW, THEN	BUILD YOUR	PROTECT YOUR	DECIDE YOUR

STEP 1 — Choose your agencies

FREE · TODAY

- List home care agencies hiring near you and their starting terms.
- Be ready for a background check and health screening — standard everywhere.

STEP 2 — Complete agency training

DAYS

- Short agency training covers safety, transfers, infection control and documentation.
- Pay attention to body mechanics — lifting injuries end these careers.

STEP 3 — Shadow, then solo

FIRST 2 WEEKS

- Shadow experienced aides with your first clients.
- Learn each client's routines and risks before working solo.

STEP 4 — Build your regular caseload

WEEKS 3-6

- Take the same clients repeatedly; continuity is the product.
- Communicate changes to the agency nurse promptly and in writing.

STEP 5 — Protect your reliability record

ONGOING

- Flawless attendance is your brand — families plan their lives around you.
- Collect references from families and coordinators as you go.

STEP 6 — Decide your next step

MONTHS 3-6

- Ask the agency about sponsored next-step training if you want more scope.
- Or begin building a private-duty roster from referrals, carefully and legally.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- ☐ Today: list agencies hiring near you; note their training and pay terms in writing.
- ☐ Days 1–30: apply to two or three agencies; complete orientation with the best fit.
- ☐ Days 31–60: first regular clients assigned; build your routine and client notes.
- ☐ Days 61–90: request consistent cases; document reliability (zero missed shifts).
- ☐ Day 90: you're a working aide with regular clients — the reference asset for whatever comes next.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest "probably NOT you". → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **CARE WHERE LIFE HAPPENS.** ★